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PolySail International

High Performance/Low Cost Sails for Small Sailboats

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She's fast and smooth under sail, yet of sufficiently shallow draft to take you where few sailboats can go.

Sectional side view and half-view of top and bottom. Slatted floor is optional. Wider planks may be preferred.

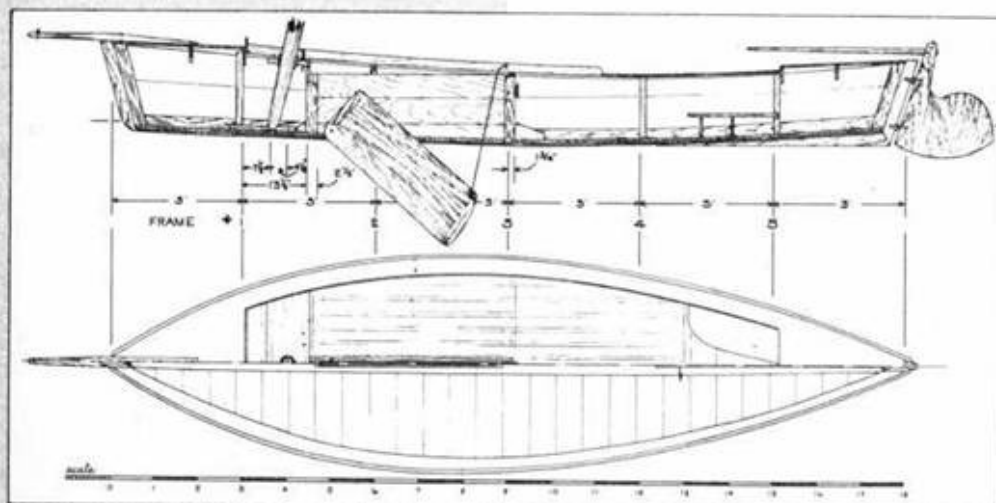
SANDY

DOWN on Chesapeake Bay these sharpies have the reputation of being "slippery as an eel." The reason is apparent, for the hull form resembles closely that of the ultra-modern 110 and 210 class boats and the spritsail rig has the tall luff and short base of up-to-date sail plans. Simplicity is the keynote of this design. That means easy and cheap building with subsequent low upkeep.

The hull should be built upside down on a form or skids made of two 4x4's—16' or 18' long laid two feet apart on a floor or leveled posts and connected with 5' long 2x4's at 3' spacings, as shown. The whole thing can be made of used lumber but it should be carefully built, preferably toenailed to the posts or floor so it won't alter shape.

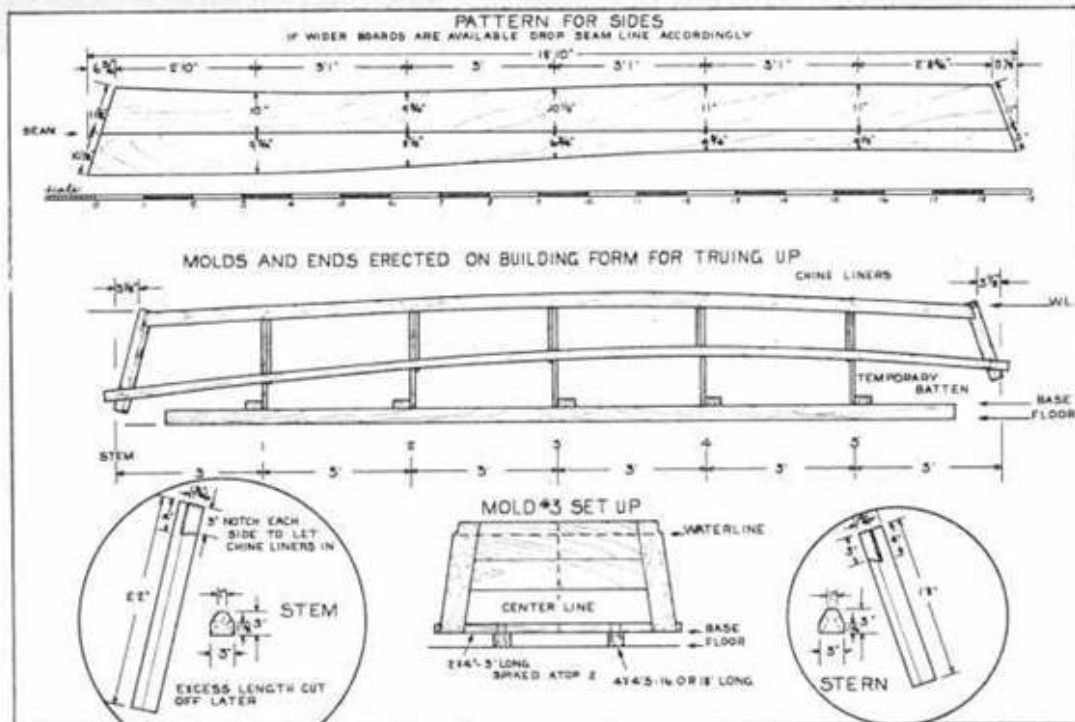
The molds can also be made of used 1" lumber, but boards should be true-edged and not warped. All necessary dimensions are given but be sure to mark waterline and centerline positions on each as made up. The sheer or underdeck line is the lower edge of the crossbanding as shown, or a mark can be made on the mold edge to represent it.

With molds completed nail to their



Double-Ended Sharpie

Simple and rugged sharpies like this 18½-footer are old time favorites on Chesapeake Bay.



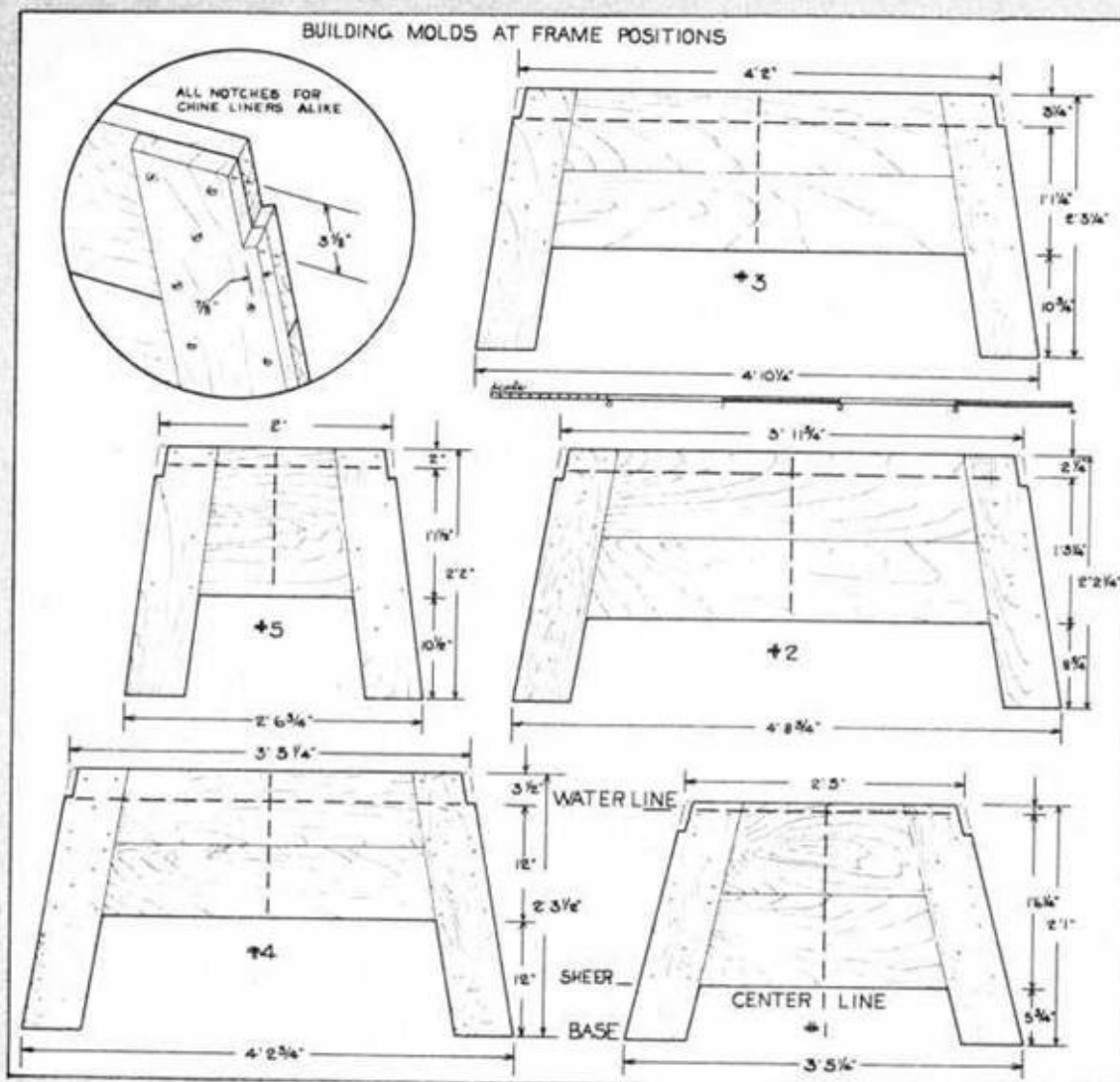
Building form, and outline of side planks. If plank width is other than as shown, use same outline, straight seam. Below: At her mooring. She'll fill the bill either sailing or fishing.

crosspieces on the form correctly centered.

Next make up the stem and stern of 3" x 3" oak or pine, beveling as shown and notching both sides for ends of chine liners. Bend the latter in their notches, allowing excess length to extend both ends. Fastenings into molds will be but temporary; use 2" finishing nails driven only partly home until satisfied as to the fairness of the chine line, then put in their places 2" f.h. screws. Check the sheer in the same way by placing a temporary 1" x 2" batten on each side with its edge on mold sheer marks, shifting slightly, if required, to have it run true, then driving temporary screw fastenings as with chine liners.

The stem can now be crowded between the extended ends of the chine liners and sheer battens, locating it so what will be its upper end is 3' ahead of position for No. 1 mold. The chine end should be 5½" in from a perpendicular above this point. The chine liners should then be sawn off to fall in their notches





Mold frames. These are set at regular frame stations during hull construction. All mold frames should be rigidly built.

and the sheer battens temporarily fastened to the stem to help hold it in place. Beveling on the edges of the stem and altering of the liner notches will probably be required for perfect fitting. Two 2" No. 12 f.h. galv. screws can be placed through each liner end into the stem. The stern is fitted in the same way.

The side boards should be cut to suit the width of material available. Let the seam line be a perfectly true edge of one of your best boards. Measure out from this the given distances at the mold spacings, then connect these points with a pencil line, using a limber batten. Finally, draw in the shape of the ends. Saw out and use as a pattern for the other side, not forgetting to transfer mold marks on it.

Remove the screws in chine liners but leave those in stem and stern. Clamp one side board to its chine liner, stem and stern, having its lower or straight edge fall on most of the mold. Use flannel soaked in liquid marine glue or heavy paint over the bevels at the ends under the boards. Clamp the opposite side in place before fastening the first to equalize the strain on the set up molds. Fastenings into the stem, stern, and liners should be 1 1/2" No. 12 f.h. galv. screws staggered in a double row an inch apart.

Before attaching the upper side planks, mark where the sheer batten falls on the molds, stem, and stern. The temporary battens can then be removed. The edges of the

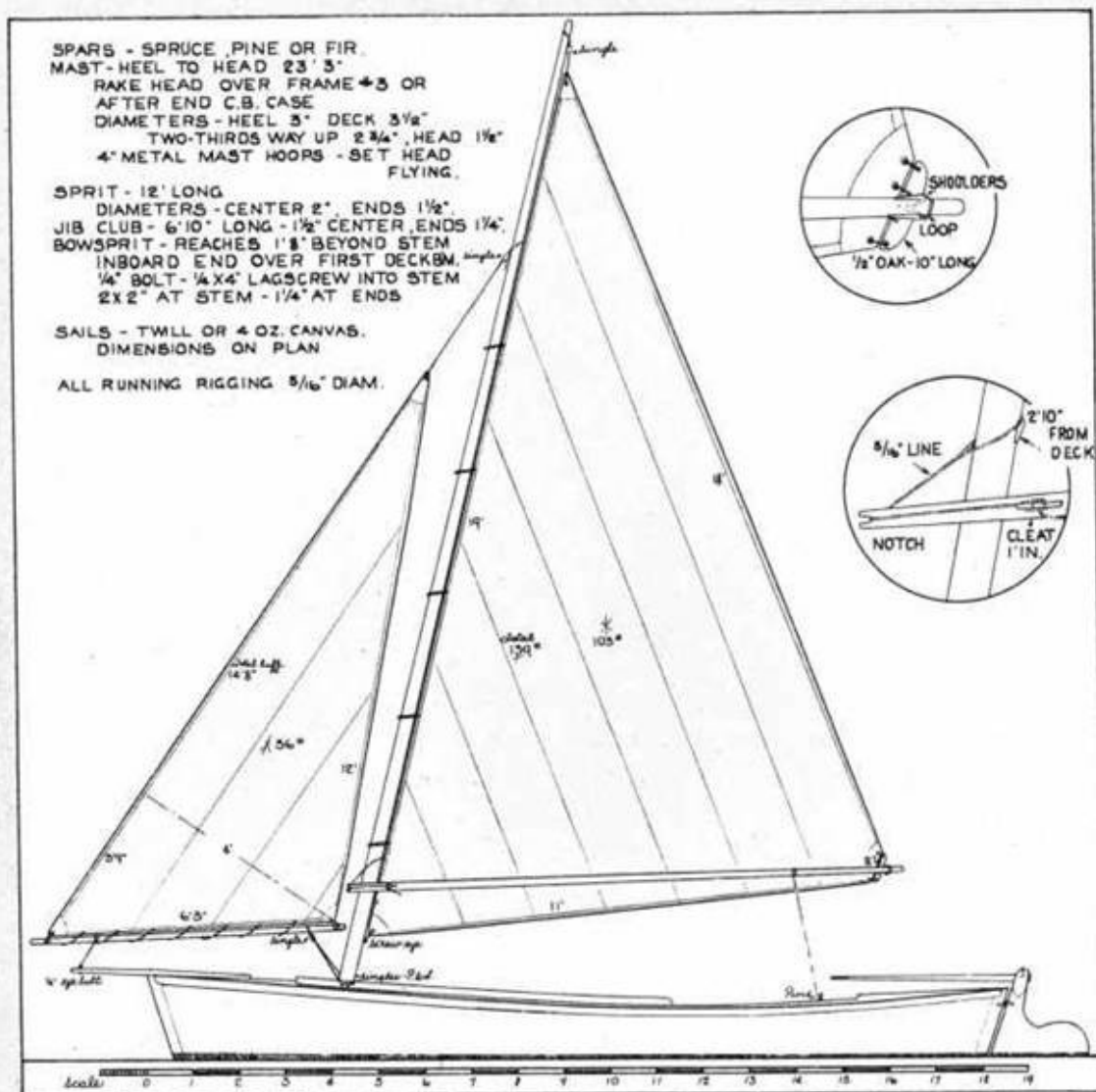
two planks should go together perfectly, merely a fine calking seam being left open. This is calked with a strand of candlewicking soaked in liquid marine glue and driven into the seam with a putty knife, then puttied flush.

Now dress off excess wood at the ends and along the chine; at the same time a straight-edge should be used across the hull to have the sides and chines flat, so the cross-planking of the bottom will hug their entire edges. The slight stem and stern projections should be sawn off so bottom boards will fit right over them.

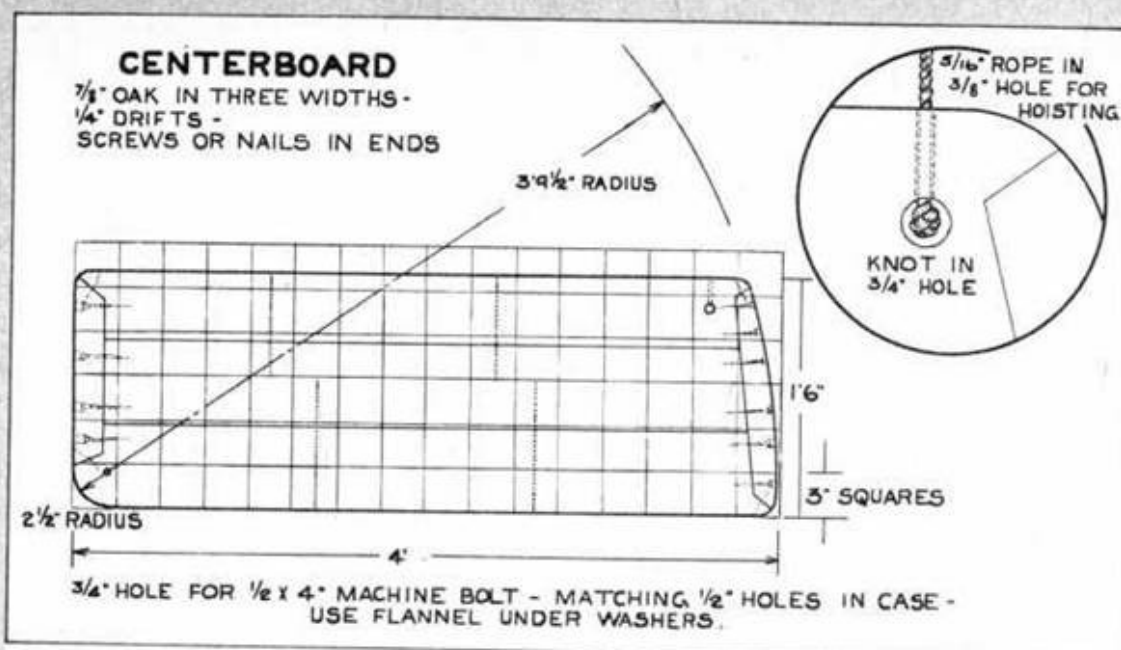
The frames can now be fitted; one along-side each mold—ahead of the two forward

ones, behind the three after ones. Cut them from 1" x 2" oak to be edge-fastened, notching out for the chine liner and cutting off at the other end to come just to the sheer. In fastening, clamp top and bottom and use 1½" screws or 2" galv. boat nails spaced 3" apart through side boards into them with a couple of screws through the frame into the liner from inside in the way of notches.

With all frames in place commence plank-ing the bottom, using ¾" boards not over 8" wide. Pay no attention to the centerboard slot now, but run the boards right across—the slot can be cut later. No calking is required here: the bottom will swell tight if



General profile and sail plan. Mast hoops are typical of Sharpie tradition. If preferred, it may be modified for mast track.



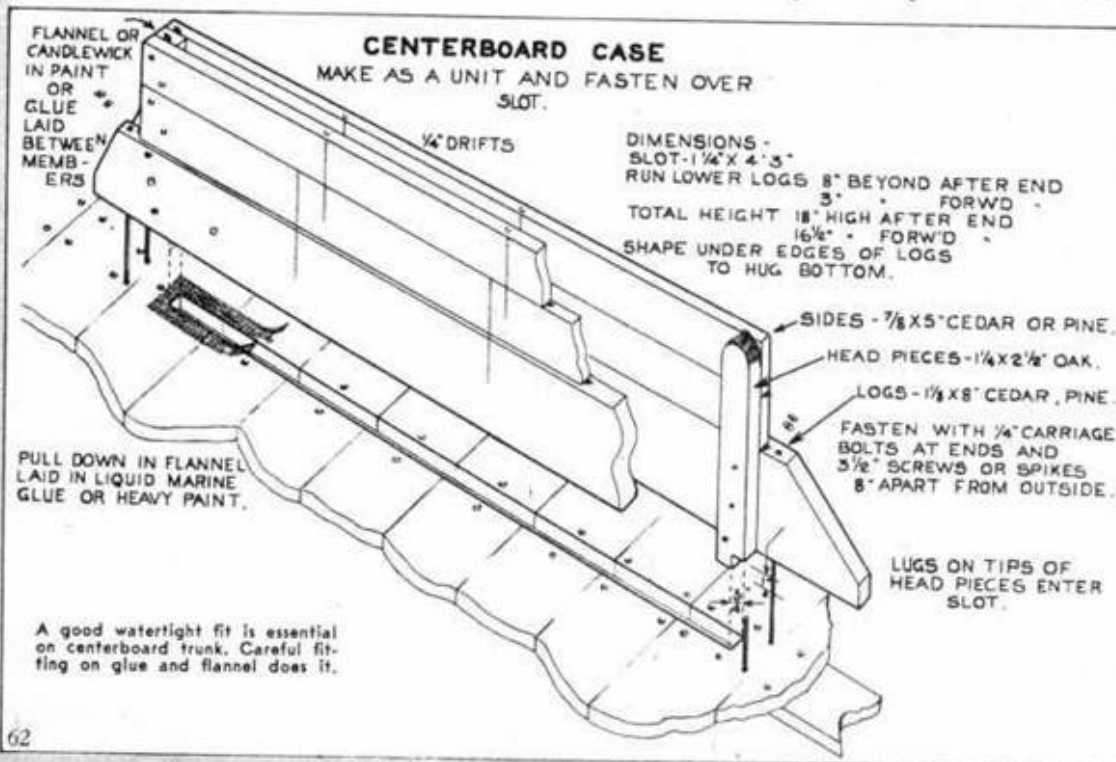
Oak planks with $\frac{1}{4}$ " drifts through seams form centerboard. Rope, not cable is used to hoist board into the centerboard trunk.

seams are band tight. A wise precaution is to lay a strip of glue or paint-soaked flannel all around the chine and over the stem and stern, then fasten planks right over it.

With the hull still on the form cut the false, or outer stem and stern from 3" x 4" pine, beveling their 4" width to cover the ends of the side planks. The stern piece should project 5" at the bottom to take the skeg, and

the stem project 1" to be faired into the keel, excess wood being sawed off later.

The keel can be worked out now and partially fastened in place; the skeg can be shaped up to run from the forward end of the keel slot to the outer stern as shown. Before completely fastening the keel, cut the 1 $\frac{1}{4}$ " wide slot for the centerboard. The keel can then be located exactly amidships and fastened in



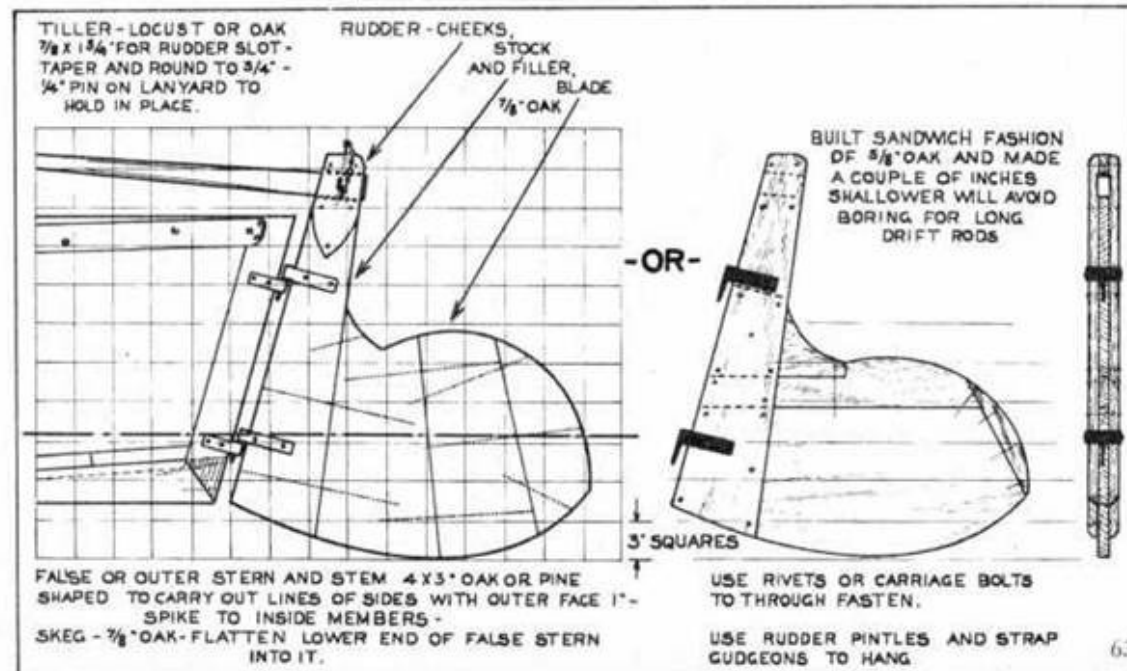
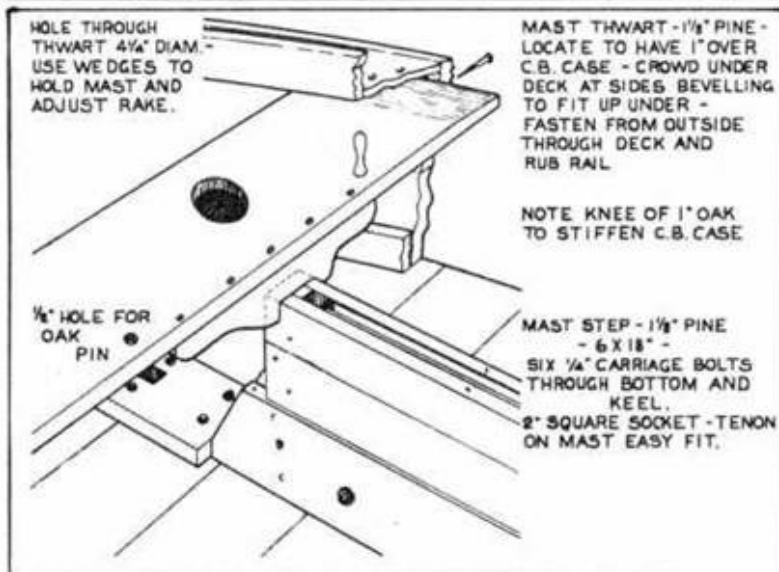
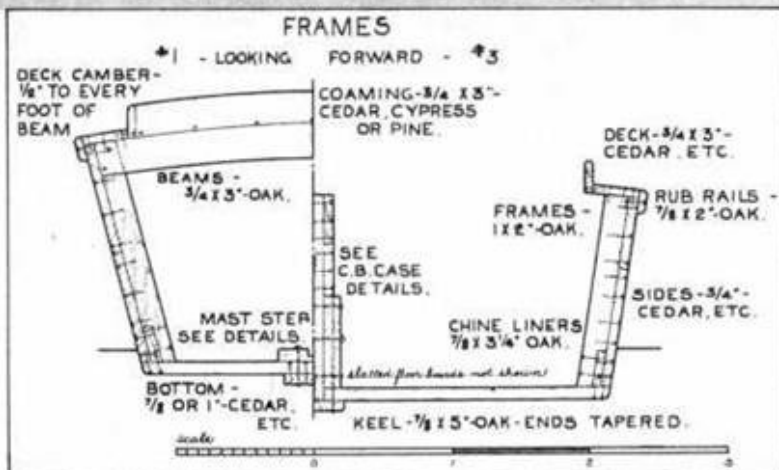
Cross-sections looking forward. Arrangement of fastenings is indicated. Center: Top trunk details.

place with half a dozen $1\frac{3}{4}$ " screws driven from outside. The skag can be forced in its slot and fastened to the outer stern. Finally, bore a tiny hole at each corner of the centerboard slot to help locate it from inside, and transfer sheer marks from the molds to the planking in preparation for removing hull from form.

Crowd three temporary crosspieces between the sides to hold them the correct distance apart. Temporary screws into the molds can then be removed and the hull either lifted clear of them or their legs sawn off for removing, when it can be turned over and placed rightside up on horses.

The c.b. slot can now be sawn through the planking to match the keel slot. Make up the [Continued on page 141]

Two rudder designs are usable as shown below. Both are popular.



Sandy—Sharpie

[Continued from page 63]

centerboard case next. This is shown in a detail sketch; note that while the keel slot is to be 4' 3" long the lugs on the head pieces will necessitate the chiseling out or lengthening of the slot in the planking $1\frac{3}{4}$ " at each end to let the lugs crowd in. They should reach to the keel but not bear against it so hard as to prevent pulling the case tight against the bottom.

The completed case is fitted in place over flannel soaked in liquid marine glue and drawn down tight with $\frac{1}{4}$ " carriage bolts at each end, and elsewhere with $3\frac{1}{2}$ " spikes or screws through bottom and keel.

Now dress the sheer down to its marks. Saw out the deckbeams for frames Nos. 1 and 5 and two more for between these frames and ends. Figure on a deck camber of $\frac{1}{2}$ " for every foot of beam at the point fitted, getting out your longest beam first and marking the center on it, when it can be used as a pattern for the others. Fasten to the frames with $1\frac{1}{2}$ " screws through beam end into frame. Now saw off tops of inner stem and stern (not the outer ones) on the sheer marks so the deck can be carried right over them. The sides will have to be beveled slightly to match the camber of the deck. The end and side decks can now be laid. The latter will be sawn out of wide boards with joints backed by butt blocks of $\frac{3}{4}$ " oak 12" long, with screw fastenings through deck into them.

The rub rails of $\frac{7}{8}$ " x 2" oak, outer corners rounded, should be bent in place now and fastened with $1\frac{1}{2}$ " screws; outer stem and stern can now be sawn off flush.

The mast step is next, and with the thwart above requires careful fitting. The bowsprit shaped as shown should be well fastened as there is no bobstay; a carriage bolt through the deckbeam and a $\frac{1}{4}$ " x 6" lag screw into the inner stem will do the trick.

The centerboard and tiller and rudder dimensions and details are shown with an alternate way of making the latter to avoid boring for long drifts.

The rig is very simple: No stays are required so the mast can be quickly lifted out of the boat whenever desired. The rake is decided by using the main halliard as a plumb-bob, having it directly over the after end of the c.b. case. The jib is laced to its full-length club and set flying (without a stay).

Large scale blueprints for Sandy are available. See page 146.

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